7.5 Creating Formulae

After entering the data in worksheet, you can perform calculations on the data in the worksheet. In order to create formulae, you first need to know the syntax that describes the format for specifying a formula.

In Calc, you can enter formulas in two methods, either directly into the cell or at the input line. Formula in Calc may start with equal (=) or plus(+) or minus(–) sign followed by a combination of values, operators and cell references. But, as a general practice, all formulas should start with an equal sign. If any formula starts with a + or –, the values will be considered as positive or negative respectively.

7.5.1 Operators

Operators are symbols for doing some mathematical, statistical and logical calculations. Combination of values, operators and cell references is called as "Expression". Calc supports a variety of operators which are categorized as:

(1) Arithmetic Opertors

2) Relational Operators

(3) Reference Operators

(4) Text Operator

7.5.1.1 Arithmetic Operators

Arithmetic operators are symbols for performing simple arithmetic operations such as addition, subtraction, multiplication, division etc., These operators return a numerical result.

Operator	Name	Value in Column B	Value in Column C	Formula in Column D	Result in Column D Operator
+	Addition	98	25	= B3 + C3	123
-	Subtraction	125	25	= B3 – C3	100
*	Multiplication	25	5	= B3 * C3	125
/	Division	90	10	= B3 / C3	9
^	Exponent	25	2	= B3 ^ C3	625
%	Percent	600		= B3 * 35%	72
Percentage (%) operator shows percentage of the content.					

Table 7.1 List of Arithmetic Operators

Formula bar shows the formula what the user had entered. But, the cell shows the resulted value (Figure 7.15).

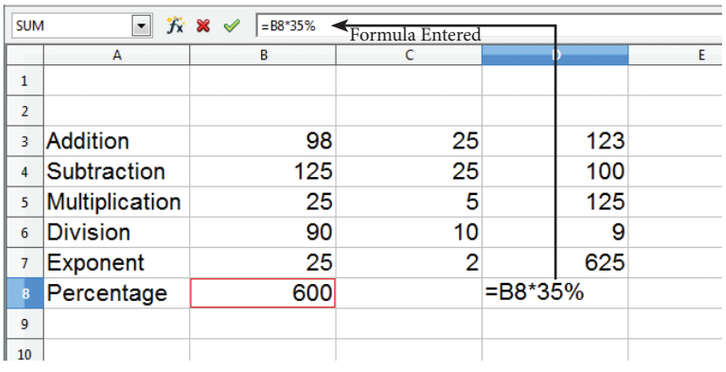


Figure 7.15 Percentage Operator

7.5.1.2 Relational Operators

Relational operators are symbols used for comparing two values such as greater than, less than, equal to etc. The relational operators are also called as ***"Comparative operators".*** These operators return either a True or a False.

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